



All you need is a GPS-enabled cellphone to experience Foursquare

special foursquare badges. This encourages competition between users to be the Mayor and to check-in at most of the venues. Users can also leave “Tips” about venues for everybody to see. These can act as recommendations or feedback for the venue either positive or negative. The social aspect of Foursquare is that you can announce and broadcast your whereabouts to your friends. Furthermore, you can integrate Twitter and Facebook to announce your location across all your social networks. As an owner of a Venue, you can claim a property via the web interface and start offering “specials” to your regular clients.

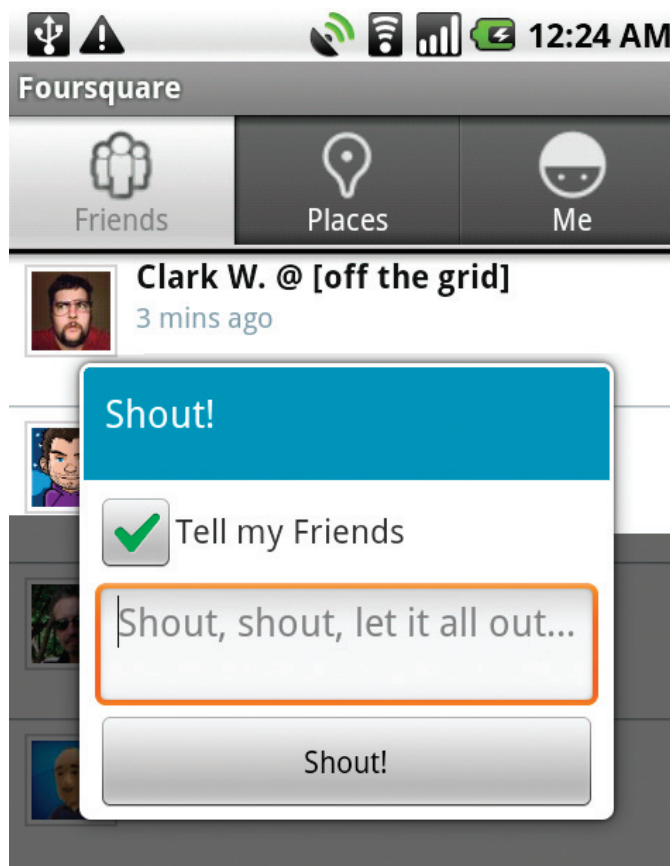
Get connected and get your friends online

As a lonesome Foursquare user, you're like a person who's trying to party alone. It doesn't

actually make sense till you have your friends or colleagues online on Foursquare. To truly experience this service, invite as many friends as you know. Once you have significant following within your circle, you can experience its innovative features to socialise, meet up, share tips, and find stuff to do when you're bored. The idea behind Foursquare is that you get rewarded for the things you do and places you visit, rather than for the people you are connected to. This way, there's really not much incentive to add random users. It's about sharing what you have been up to with friends.

Maintain privacy

Make sure to never add people you aren't really friends with, like many people commonly do on other social networking sites. Unlike Facebook, where the emphasis is on increasing



That's broadcasting from your handset!

your social circle, with Foursquare, it's all about sharing information and forming a group. This is because if you have the Foursquare app enabled on your phone and are sharing your GPS location, your friends will be able to see your location unless you properly manage your privacy settings. Therefore be careful who you are inviting to connect on Foursquare, you don't want to be inviting some stranger to meet up with you at some place you normally visit, or be stalked. Also, be careful not to divulge too much information about your whereabouts on location-based services such as Foursquare.

Personalise check ins

Simply checking in and tagging yourself at different places doesn't completely satisfy the motive of location-based social networking. Instead, you can choose to get connected to

your friends visiting different places via SMS or 'shouts'. You can also make use of shouts to organise meet ups or parties. You can use Foursquare as a connection platform to let your friends know that they have been invited to join you as well. To do this, simply send them a text message about the specified event and the venue.

Share reviews about the places you visit

If you are already connected to a few of your friends and colleagues, you should be receiving pop-up updates whenever you check into different venues your friends have already been to. These pop-ups are tips or reviews people in your network have left at the venue. Suggestions like “try the cheese garlic naan” from people you know are obviously more trust worthy than any faceless reviews you might read on city guides or the internet.



You can make new friends within the city you live in with Foursquare